

Chapter 154_2 - Five Years

Walking all the way to the depths of the demon cavern, a black and gold lacquered palace appeared before them. The palace was several zhang¹ high, with several strings of fluorite hanging at the entrance, polished into pearl-like shapes that flickered like fireflies in the darkness.

Two rows of beauties stood guard outside the door, all with hibiscus faces and willow-like figures. Jiuying² stopped at the palace entrance and waved for those beauties to disperse, then called out: "Demon Lord, someone seeks an audience."

The palace was quiet for a while, then a cold voice came from within: "This lord has said before that no immortal race may step foot in my Demon Realm. Yet you presume to bring someone here. Are you tired of living?"

Jiuying bit her red lips until they turned white, then suddenly raised her head and sneered: "You have the ability, then kill me."

Hearing this, Chu Qingqiu's heart tightened. She saw a black shadow fly out from the palace - an Emei needle shooting like an arrow toward Jiuying's throat. Chu Qingqiu frowned and was about to throw out her White Bone³, but Jiuying gestured behind her back that it was fine.

Then Jiuying seemed already familiar with this development. She held her pale neck high without moving, so the Emei needle brushed past her neck and embedded itself into a giant stone outside the palace with a thud.

Looking closely, that giant stone had already been punctured countless times, looking like a lotus pod.

"Come in, Divine Venerable." Jiuying winked at Chu Qingqiu with her beautiful eyes, then lifted aside those fluorite strings.

Chu Qingqiu clenched her palms, put away her White Bone, then walked step by step into the entrance with a pounding heart.

She hadn't yet adjusted to the dim light inside the palace when demonic energy swirled before her eyes. Then coolness pressed against her neck, and she felt the impact against her back. Chu Qingqiu suddenly met a pair of eyes.

The woman wore a golden crown with cloud ribbons on her shoulders, draped in darkness like night as she pinned her against the wall. The brilliantly pink Xiangsi sword⁴ at her throat illuminated the woman's face.

These were the eyebrows and eyes she had longed for day and night for years, not a single detail different, sharp as blades and swords, beautifully piercing into the depths of her heart.

So under the woman's puzzled gaze, Chu Qingqiu's already reddened eyes suddenly moistened, then tears fell drop by drop. The scalding tears wet the sword blade and flowed down along the sword.

The tears seemed to burn. Ning Fuyi felt uncomfortable touching them and unconsciously loosened her sword.

"Ning Fuyi!" Jiuying stepped forward and pulled her away, nearly knocking a couple of chestnuts on her head. "If you really hurt her, you'll be the one regretting it forever!"

Ning Fuyi glanced at her but didn't strike again. She just stared straight at the tearful Chu Qingqiu, not speaking for a long while, lost in thought.

The woman leaned against the wall, silently crying with pursed lips. The originally cold person was like a peach blossom in rain, pitifully touching people's hearts.

"I didn't even use force." Ning Fuyi's heart inexplicably softened seeing her cry, so she muttered and threw down her sword, turning away. "This lord doesn't like the immortal race. If there's nothing important, leave quickly to avoid real suffering."

Chu Qingqiu couldn't speak, but Jiuying's eyes rolled a few times, suddenly breaking into a smile as she stepped forward to dust off nonexistent dirt from Ning Fuyi's shoulder.

"Didn't the Demon Lord say a few days ago that none of the attendants around you were satisfactory and you wanted to change them? Well, this person is perfect." Jiuying coaxed. "You dislike Han Ya⁵ for being too noisy, Xi Que⁶ for being clumsy, and the other demon servants are ugly."

"Look at this person - high immortal power, careful thoughts, and most importantly, beautiful." Jiuying turned Ning Fuyi's head, forcing her to stare at Chu Qingqiu.

For some reason, seeing her cry made Ning Fuyi feel uncomfortable, so she looked away but relented.

"Indeed beautiful," she said.

"Then it's settled. Shangchou⁷ has something to discuss with me, so I'll take my leave." Seeing that she had relented, Jiuying immediately turned to close the door, transforming into red light and slipping away.

Only the two remained in the palace. Seeing the person crying miserably, Ning Fuyi truly couldn't bear it and took out a handkerchief to offer: "Stop crying. Though I'm a demon, I don't kill people on sight. What are you afraid of?"

However, that person didn't take her handkerchief but slowly straightened up and staggered toward her.

Then, as if suddenly losing strength, she closed her tear-filled eyes and softly collapsed toward her. Her body wrapped in wide robes and long sleeves was too thin to grasp properly, yet her clothes filled Ning Fuyi's entire embrace.

Footnotes:

- ¹ **Zhang (丈)** - A traditional Chinese unit of measurement, approximately 3.3 meters or 10.8 feet.
- ² **Jiuying (九婴)** - Character name referring to a nine-headed mythical beast from Chinese mythology.
- ³ **White Bone (白骨)** - Chu Qingqiu's weapon, likely a bone-colored or bone-made sword/staff.
- ⁴ **Xiangsi sword (相思剑)** - Literally "Lovesickness sword," Ning Fuyi's divine weapon that responds to deep love and emotion.
- ⁵ **Han Ya (寒鸦)** - Character name meaning "cold crow."
- ⁶ **Xi Que (喜鹊)** - Character name meaning "magpie."
- ⁷ **Shangchou (商仇)** - A character name, likely another demon in the realm.